



SHAMASH

The attendant candle — the one that lights the others,
then stands to the side.

A chief of staff for your WhatsApp · Runs on your machine · No cloud, no account

START HERE — 5 minutes of reading, and you will know what you just installed

Something that reads your WhatsApp so you don't have to

Twice a day it goes through everything that arrived, handles what is obviously handleable, and sends you **one message**: what it did, what it put in your calendar, and what it deliberately left for you — with the reason.

The rest of the time it sits there and waits for you to ask it something. You message it the way you message a person: *"what did I miss in the work group?"*, *"am I free Thursday morning?"*, *"remind me to call the garage tomorrow"*. It answers in the same chat, in your language.

THE DIGEST

Twice a day, one message

Everything that happened, sorted: what it handled, what it booked, what needs you, and what it ignored as noise.

ON DEMAND

Message it like a person

Questions, calendar, catching up on a group you have ignored for a week, finding a file on your own computer.

IT ACTS

Books, replies, reminds

A clear "can we meet Tuesday at 10?" gets checked against your calendar and booked — or two alternative slots offered.

IT LEARNS

Correct it once

Tell it "answer shorter" or "always leave that to me" and it rewrites its own instructions. The correction survives.

What it is not. Not a cloud service, not a bot account, not a company. There is no server holding your messages and no one to sign up with. It is a program on your computer, using your WhatsApp, that stops the moment you close it.

A normal Tuesday

One digest in the morning, one in the evening, and whatever you ask in between. That is the whole product.

Shamash · 08:00

✓ **Handled**

- **Dana** — asked if Thursday 10:00 works. You were free, booked it.
- **Roofing group** — sent the address they asked for; it was in the chat.

📅 **Booked**

- Dana — coffee, Thu 10:00–10:30 · reminder: call the garage, 16:00

⚠️ **Needs you**

- **Michael** — wants a price for the job. Money, so I left it.
- **Mum** — asked twice about the weekend. Not my call to answer.

📄 41 other messages, nothing in them.

You · 11:20

what happened in the project group this week? I stopped reading it

Shamash

Three things. The deadline moved to the 14th. The client rejected the second design. And Ron asked *you*, twice, if you can be there Sunday — nobody answered him.

You · 11:21

tell him yes, I'll be there

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Sent, in the group, in your usual tone. Also added Sunday to your calendar.

You · 18:40

stop replying in that group unless someone tags me

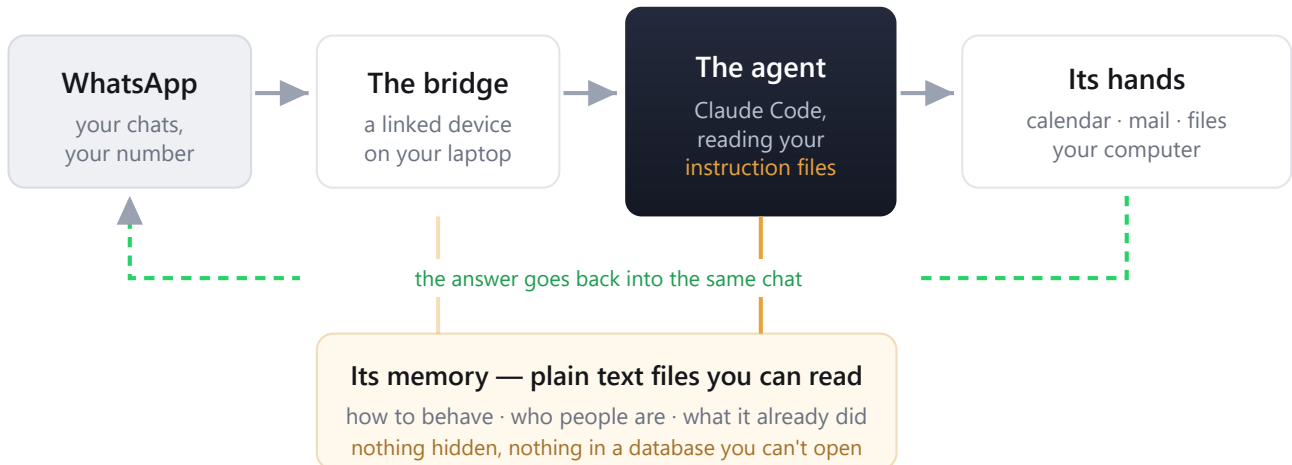
Shamash

Noted — I wrote it into my instructions, so it holds from now on, not just today.

Notice the last exchange. No setting, no menu — you said it in the chat and it edited its own rulebook. That is how most of its behaviour gets built.

How it actually works

No magic, and worth understanding — because when something breaks, you will know which of the four boxes to look at.



STEP 1

It sees

The bridge is a linked device, like WhatsApp Web. Messages land in a file on your own disk.

STEP 2

It thinks

A watcher wakes the agent and hands it the new messages plus its instruction files — its whole character in plain text.

STEP 3

It acts

Calendar, mail, your files, a shell. Only what the rules allow, and every action is written down.

STEP 4

It reports

The answer goes back into the same chat. Nothing counts as sent until it is confirmed as delivered.

Its mind is a folder of text files

There is no training, no model of you sitting on a server. Everything it knows about how to be you is a handful of Markdown files on your disk. Open them. Edit them. They are the product.

FILE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHO WRITES IT
The brief	Its constitution — your tone, what it may do alone, what it must never touch, how the digest is written.	You, then it
People	Who is who. The nickname in your phone, the real name, how you talk to them. Tell it once, it writes the row itself.	It, from you
Jobs	What each scheduled run is for — the morning scan, the evening digest, anything else you add later.	The kit
Skills	A procedure worth reusing. "Summarise a group like this" — saved once, used forever.	It, on request
The log	Every action it took, one line each, so it can never act twice on the same message.	It

This is the difference between it being generic and it being yours. On day one it behaves like a careful stranger. After a week of you correcting it in the chat — "shorter", "never answer him without me", "that group is noise" — the brief has grown into something that only fits you. That file is the thing worth backing up.

Teaching it, in practice

Three sentences you can send it today, and what each one permanently changes.

- 1 "Ron is my brother-in-law, he runs the site."**
 A row appears in the People file. From now on it knows the tone and the context without asking.
- 2 "Keep your digests to ten lines."**
 It edits its own brief. Every future digest is shorter — not just the next one.
- 3 "Save that as a skill."**
 Whatever it just did well becomes a written procedure it will follow the same way next month.

What it will never do on its own

These are not suggestions in a prompt — they are the rules it is handed on every single run, and they are the reason it can be trusted with a WhatsApp account that is genuinely yours.

- **Never message someone who isn't already in the conversation.** It answers; it does not start relationships.
- **Never discuss money.** Prices, quotes, discounts, payments — it stops and hands the message to you.
- **Never agree to anything binding.** Contracts, commitments, anything sensitive goes on the "needs you" list.
- **Never delete or edit anything.** Not messages, not files, not events.
- **Never more than two replies in one chat per run.** If a conversation is really moving, that is a sign it needs you, not more automation.
- **In groups, only when spoken to.** It acts on messages that mention you or clearly ask you, and stays silent otherwise.

And the honest part. It is a language model with your WhatsApp and a shell on your computer. It will occasionally misread a chat, answer something it should have left, or phrase you badly. Nothing here is recoverable by an undo button — a sent message is sent.

That is why the first week matters: leave it on the tight settings, read every digest properly, and loosen it only where it has earned it. If a chat should never be touched, say so — it will write that down too.

Three things only you can do

Pair it	Scanning the WhatsApp code needs your phone. ~20 seconds, once.
Authorise calendar	Your Google account, in your browser. It cannot do that for you.
Leave the machine on	No computer, no agent. It is not a phone app and never will be.

NOW

Try these five, in this order

Send them exactly as they are, in the chat you are reading this in. Each one shows you a different half of the thing.

what's on my calendar today?

am I free Thursday morning?

catch me up on the busiest group I've ignored this week

remind me tomorrow at 9 to send the invoice

who wrote to me today and got no answer?

Then leave it alone until the next digest. That is the honest test — not what it does when you are watching, but what it hands you when you were not.

IF IT GOES QUIET

Check the machine

Nine times in ten it is the computer asleep, or the bridge lost its link. Ask it "are you alive?" — if nothing comes back, restart it.

IF IT GETS IT WRONG

Tell it, in the chat

Plain words. "That was too long." "Don't answer her without me." It edits its own brief and shows you what it changed.

One last thing. Everything here runs on your machine, under your account, with your files. Nobody else can see any of it — and equally, nobody else is watching it for you. It is yours to run, and yours to check.

The candle lights the room. You still decide what happens in it.

Full details in the repository: [README.md](#) to install, [RISKS.md](#) before you do, [docs/ARCHITECTURE.md](#) if you want the wiring.